GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

July 11th, 2025
Week 28
Volume 274, Issue 1193

Highlights:

- **Terminal tariffs.**
- **Regulations bite.**
- **Rising reticence.**
- **Weaker time.**
- **Gov impacts.**
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QUOTE of the WEEK

"You don't have to see the whole staircase, just take the first step."

– Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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SUMMER SUFFERANCE!

Trump's twisted tariff tantrums went terminal this week after his self-imposed July 1st deadline to major U.S. trade partners on presenting potential proposals to offset his tariffs saw no response from trading nations that were in his crosshairs. As a result, a new deadline of August 1st, 2025, has been put forth as the final date to respond, all while tariffs ranging from 15% to 50% on nations from Bangladesh to Brazil are reportedly set to automatically kick into gear by the end of this month. Expectedly, stock markets went haywire in the early hours of Friday trading and sent virtually every major index into a tailspin, defying their collective performances across recent weeks. And while U.S. inflation continues to rise, the U.S. Dollar yoyoed against all of the major ship recycling nation currencies, even seeing the Turkish Lira finally breach the dreaded TRY 40 mark this week. Local steel plate prices also surprised everyone the industry as all ship recycling destinations (even China) saw levels climb in unison this week. And while the news certainly seems positive for upcoming vessel pricing, recycling tonnage remains amiss at the bidding tables as the Baltic Exchange reported a 13.5% jump in the freight index this week, primarily on the back of the Cape index that jumped a whopping 26.4%, whilst the Panamax and Supramax indices added 8% and 2% respectively.

In the interim, international ship recycling markets continue suffering over these summer / monsoon months as prices fall and an overall temperament of diminishing demand settles in on the back of volatile fundamentals, a Hong Kong Convention that finally came into effect on June 26th, a rising reticence amongst recyclers from offering firm on potential units, and ship owners and cash buyers who remain hesitant to test the higher priced offerings from the yet-to-be certified HKC yards in Pakistan, simply on the basis on an interim DASR certificate issued to the yard. Increased regulatory and documentary demands also continue to cause confusion / consternation writ large, and this is likely adding to the reduced number of candidates on show. While several large(r) LDT units such as LNGs and even a VLOC have been recycled over the last few months, it has remained a trickle in the supply of tonnage throughout the year, against the backdrop of an expectedly busier 2025. Surprisingly however, this week has seen the number of units and (especially) the volume of LDT at certain destinations improve, and markedly at that.

As a result, incessant market volatilities have seen fundamentals drive prices from the highs of USD 600/Ton in January of 2024, down to below 400/LDT on certain vessels given that one Handymax bulker was concluded at about USD 390/LDT into Bangladesh last week, as market movements scare potential owners off. Although this has traditionally been a slower time of the year for ship recycling markets given that the incessant rains drench the landscape, leading to partial yard closures and laborers returning to hometowns as cutting / ship recycling activities slow and recycled steel fails to shift to re-rolling mills. Governments too, have their roles to play in stimulating their economies as there have been contrasting fortunes in Bangladesh, India and Pakistan over the last year, leaving prices precariously poised at the mid-way point of this year, with still no clarity ahead. At the far end, as the Turkish Lira enters uncharted territory, Aliaga recyclers managed to snag a unit?

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 28 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

STUCK IN THE MUCK!

Lowest for year.

Amidst the incredible torrent of rains, the Bangladeshi market remains stuck in the muck at the bottom of the market rankings as both demand and pricing on prospective tonnage turn miserable and fall to the lowest level they have been since January of 2024, when a container vessel was sold at a massive price of USD 600/Ton to a local recycler. And while there have been deals concluded below the USD 400/LDT mark, for the time being at least, it seems that a healthy majority (if not all) of the tonnage being introduced for a recycling sale that is / can be a Chattogram candidate, is being introduced with the intention of being diverted to competing sub-continent markets with their higher levels on show, even if the unit is opening up in the Far East or is geographically better-suited for a Bangladesh redelivery.

Below 400/LDT.

A big part of the problem remains with the fact that there are very few yards actively negotiating for tonnage as only 12 have thus far managed to get their HKC affairs in order and have already taken in a bevy of deliveries over the last month. A remaining 10 are still scrambling to get their certifications in order before local authorities start dishing out NOCs on future units destined to these yet-to-be certified yards. Rising confusion on the new regulations has not only exacerbated ship owners, cash buyers, and ship recyclers alike, but it turns out that even local authorities are seeming to "cope" with the additional changes themselves as reportedly, the newly formed Ship Recycling Board ended up issuing an NOC in favor of an uncertified yard this week, further causing confusion amongst those recyclers still working towards their HKC goals.

Interim failures.

Further shortcomings lie with the interim government that has meanwhile failed to stimulate the domestic economy ever since they took office after the collapse of ex-PM Sheikh Hasina and her regime in June of 2024. The nation has struggled with infrastructure projects ever since, causing local steel inventories to continue stockpiling at local yards due to clearly high local steel plate prices, which was made worse by the shocking news that local steel mills had reportedly booked imported steel at region USD 330/Ton just last week.

Oopsies.

Rather surprisingly, local steel plate prices resumed trading once again mid-week and even opened about USD 3/Ton higher than last at about USD 552/Ton, where they flatlined till close of Friday. But the biggest boost to the local mindset is the massive jump in the Bangladeshi Taka that firmed an impressive 1.27% against the U.S. Dollar, closing the week out at BDT 121.40, after hitting an impressive low of BDT 120.62 mid-week. Adding to the silver-linings is the fact that another large LNG arrived local anchorage, bumping the total LDT at Chattogram to over 42K this week.

Overall, amidst the shaky offerings, bottom of the market levels, reported renegotiations at the waterfront, unpredictable fundamentals, and oopsies from local authorities certainly leave much to be desired for, from a market that was the recycling leader for a majority of the year and is now struggling to merely maintain balance amidst a serious "list" in its Q3 2025 performance.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

MIS-FIRING!

While Bangladesh and Pakistan's efforts at the bidding tables have been arrested for one reason or another, India has struggled, yet managed to pick up some of the slack with mixed results thus far. And while both of its competing neighbours (yes, even Pakistan) managed to get at least one unit each, India remained the leader of the pack with nearly 70K LDT of larger LDT tonnage arrivals and deliveries just this week, bumping the total number of vessels and tonnage at Alang anchorage to 6 and nearly 104K LDT respectively. Certainly, an impressive number given that the number of market offerings over the last month have been greatly diminished due to fluctuating international trade policies from a White House that has once again aggravated a miscalculated trade war, whereby a potential 35% tariffs would likely be applied against Indian imports.

Mixed results.

Although this did see the Indian Rupee drop 42 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and end the week at Rs. 85.80, local steel plate prices were the ones that climbed another (nearly) USD 3/Ton through the week, closing it out at nearly USD 430/Ton and shifting potential upcoming fixtures further into the green. India's exports and overall GDP also continues to strengthen as the Reserve Bank of India reported U.S. Dollar reserves to have increased to over USD 702 Billion this week, further cementing the nation's financial independence and ability to fund domestic projects, as the country's economic trajectory (and growth) continues along the right path under PM Modi.

No specialist.

On the ship recycling front as well, having 10 times the number of approved yards in the Indian sub-continent than its competing neighbours, Alang recyclers remain well equipped to handle the inflow of tonnage no matter the volume. And while the single major caveat has been price, which itself has been on the drop for a few weeks now, recent HKC changes / requirements have seen both owners and cash buyers unwilling to accept even higher offers from Pakistan or geographically cheaper / more profitable deals into Bangladesh - as has been evident from ongoing fixtures / arrivals at both competing locations. Non-ferrous vessels (including Moss type LNGs and stainless-steel tankers) and specialist units (reefers, passenger vessels etc) have also been heading to Alang this year, but as has been the sign of the times, these too have started to dry up of late.

Steel down.

Overall, with fundamentals (especially steel plate prices) demonstrating some return / positivity over recent weeks (having firmed nearly USD 6/Ton) and the Indian Rupee also seeming to be stable despite being shaky in the Rs. 85 - Rs. 86 region, it might not be too long before India squeezes past Pakistan into first place. Either on account of India's firming fundamentals or Pakistan's weakening Rupee that could compel Gadani recyclers to pull back their levels and inadvertently slide themselves into 2nd. Whatever remains the case, Indian still remains the go-to destination for ship recycling today.

Into 1st.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

BACKING IT UP?

Snafus.

Although market tonnage has been hit-or-miss of late, on the back of several private units proposed and being the highest placed sub-continent market at present, Pakistani recyclers have reportedly been busy negotiating units as news came forth on several dry bulk units (including Panamax and Handymax bulkers) being reportedly fixed locally, on the basis of local authorities confirming provisional DASR certificates to the relevant negotiating yards that have demonstrated that HKC upgrades are ongoing and presently under way. And while the delivery of these upcoming fixtures will certainly be interesting when the time comes (given that Chattogram authorities have themselves been committing snafus over the new regulations), it will be just as interesting to keep an eye out on upcoming deliveries at Gadani's waterfront, for the types and sizes of units that will make it here and how this market struggles to catch up to HKC standards.

Leading the way.

Speaking of the waterfront, the markets were surprised to witness a smallish nearly 6K LDT Bulk Carrier make it to Gadani's waterfront front this week, likely to one of the ship recyclers who has demonstrated a degree of improvement to his ship recycling yard, as the timeline of her final delivery to the end buyer remains key at this time given that the vessel is still idling outside.

As local offerings continue holding up above the psychological USD 400/LDT mark while offers on various vessels in both India and Bangladesh have been below that level, it may not be long before Pakistan's offerings follow the trail of the gang – as they have historically done so when determining where local levels should stand. And if the case of the recent fixtures stands true, we certainly encourage ship owners to grab this window of opportunity and fix at the currently higher level from Pakistan before fundamentals drag local offerings down, just like their neighboring competition has been suffering through of late.

HKC moves.

The Pakistani Rupee has become a bone of contention for the domestic ship recycling fraternity as it has consistently declined over the last 5 weeks, falling another 15 basis points this week and closing at PKR 283.40 against the U.S. Dollar, whilst briefly spiking above PKR 285 on more than one occasion through the week. Local steel plate prices however, cushioned some of the Rupee-induced fear that saw steel climb nearly USD 4/Ton and close the week out at nearly USD 619/Ton – still the highest in the industry. And thankfully something local recyclers of impending deliveries should be able to enjoy the fruits of as long as cheap Chinese steel doesn't flood this market.

Streamlined process.

Overall, the Pakistani remains a market of concern, not only because this destination is more prone to delivery hiccups than the market has been providing its own; adding additional formalities into a market where neither the importer nor the imposer of the law knows exactly how to abide by it, makes it a hit-or-miss market until a few deliveries have streamlined the process.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SURPRISE WEEK!

Natural evolution.

The Turkish ship-recycling fraternity has managed to surprise once again as not only has the Lira finally passed the point of no return, collapsing 82 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and closing the week out at TRY 40.20, but an approximately 3K LDT General Cargo vessel has reportedly been concluded to a local recycler at levels region USD 260/MT.

This is impressive for 2 reasons as firstly, the dearth of tonnage has driven Aliaga recyclers out of their offices and into international markets, directly attempting to locate and negotiate tonnage for their yards, but secondly, their attempts at doing so have helped them establish relations that are further driving them to become pseudo cash buyers for others in the local fraternity, which likely resulted in the above mentioned private sale.

Certainly, pleasing to see the natural evolution of ship recycling.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 28 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Weak**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	India	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *Poison dart frogs are only poisonous if you feed them toxic bugs. They are perfectly safe to handle if you feed them crickets. Scientists believe the bugs poison dart frogs eat — like formicine ants —are what make them so poisonous. So, zoos feed poison dart frogs a different diet —namely, crickets or fruit flies — which allows zookeepers to handle the frogs without the risk of being poisoned. There's currently no treatment or antidote for their toxins, too.*
- *Babies have more bones than adults. A lot more. Babies are born with about 300 bones, whereas adults have 206 bones. As babies get older, some of their bones begin to fuse together. For instance, babies tend to have soft spots on their heads, which feel a lot different than the hard heads we adults have. Well, as babies age, those soft spots "close up" as the bones in their head fuse, giving them the skulls we have as adults.*
- *Froot Loops are all just one flavor. Despite the various colors, Froot Loops are reportedly all one flavor, which is a blend of orange, lemon, lime, apple, cherry, raspberry, and blueberry. Fun fact: Trix and Fruity Pebbles — two other rainbow, fruity-flavored cereals — are also just one flavor.*
- *Animals can see completely different colors than us. Pretty wild when you think about it. Many animals can see colors that we as humans cannot. For instance, birds, reptiles, honeybees, and some bony fish have the ability to see ultraviolet light, which is outside our range of "visible light." Though humans and bees can both be looking at the same flower, for example, we're seeing them in different ways and colors. On the flip side, some animals, like dogs and cats, see fewer colors than we do and see them more weakly.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 09 – Raksha Bandhan August 15 – Independence Day August 16 - Janmashtami	July 08 – July 16 July 21 – July 29 August 08 – August 16 August 20 – August 27

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 05 – July Mass Uprising Day August 15 – National Mourning Day August 16 - Janmashtami	July 11 – July 14 July 24 – July 27 August 09 – August 12

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
No holidays until September	August 14 – Independence Day	July 15 – Democracy & National Solidarity Day August 30 – Victory Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of July 11, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
2	*Enterprise*	*16,480*	*Container*	*Delivered July 10*
3	*Inda*	*17,647*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered July 11*
4	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
5	**Run Fu 2**	**6,183**	**Bulk Carrier**	**Arrived June 04**
6	*Techno*	*34,047*	*LNG Carrier*	*Delivered July 10*
Total Tonnage		**103,980**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of July 11, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Ang Min*	*11,243*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered July 02*
2	Rasi	30,771	LNG Carrier	Arrived July 06
		42,014		

GADANI - Port Position as of July 11, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Winca	5,964	Bulk Carrier	Arrived July 10
Total Tonnage		**5,964**		

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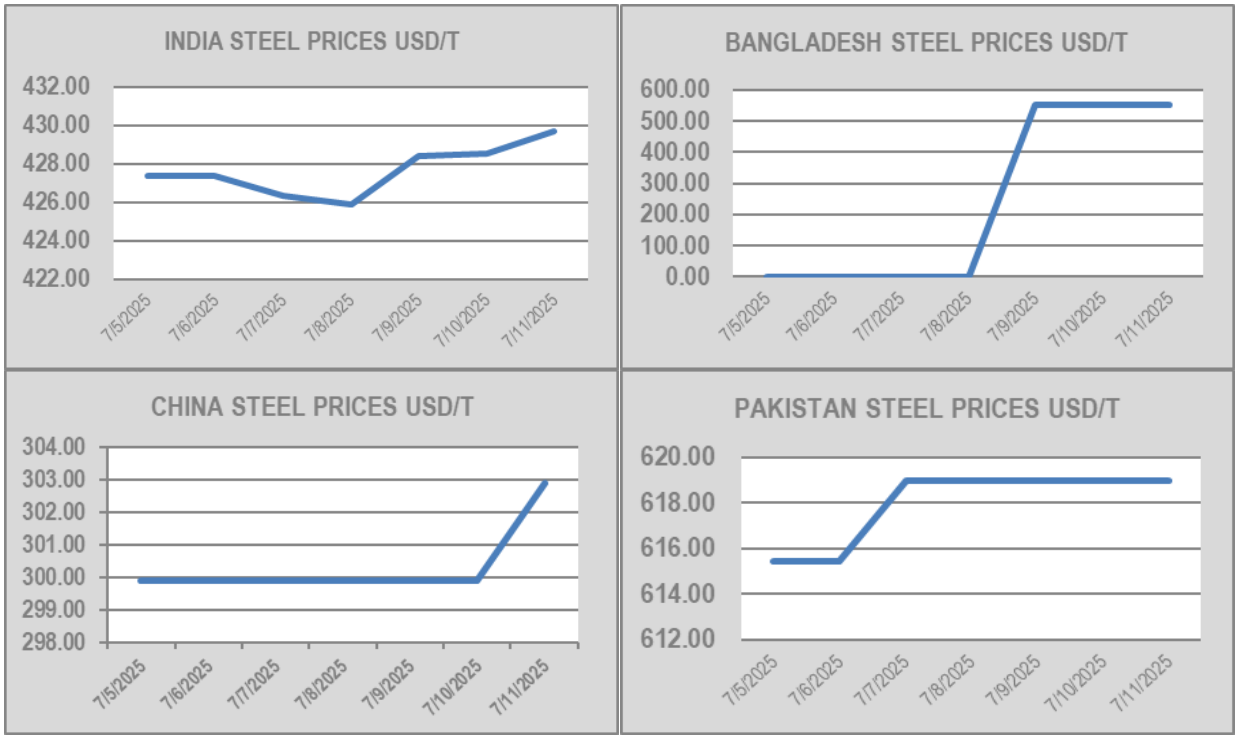
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
7/5/2025	427.40	36,500.00	615.44	175,000.00	NO SALES	NO SALES	299.90
7/6/2025	427.40	36,500.00	615.44	175,000.00	NO SALES	NO SALES	299.90
7/7/2025	426.32	36,600.00	618.96	176,000.00	NO SALES	NO SALES	299.90
7/8/2025	425.90	36,500.00	618.96	176,000.00	NO SALES	NO SALES	299.90
7/9/2025	428.39	36,700.00	618.96	176,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	299.90
7/10/2025	428.54	36,700.00	618.96	176,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	299.90
7/11/2025	429.72	36,900.00	618.96	176,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	302.90



www.gmsinc.net GMS_Leadership GMS Leadership snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037
Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311